

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Diverse Perspectives on the State - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Diverse Perspectives on the State

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

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Critical, Communitarian, Gandhian, Feminist and Pluralist Thinkers

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Indian Application and Proposition Method

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Diverse Perspectives on the State - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g2 **PYQ ownership:** No directly owned verified PYQ is assigned to this topic; all questions below are original practice.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Organic theory**?

A. the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223). B. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270). C. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236). D. they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Organic theory** with **the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which theory treats the state as a natural ethical whole and individuals as functionally related parts?

A. Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick B. Organic theory C. Gandhi D. Laissez-faire individualism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223)** with **Organic theory**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Social-contract theory**?

A. the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273). B. laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277). C. the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236). D. he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Social-contract theory** with **the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which theory justifies an artificial state through agreement designed to overcome the defects of a state of nature?

A. J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver B. Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged C. Welfare / positive liberal state D. Social-contract theory

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236)** with **Social-contract theory**. The

other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Laissez-faire individualism**?

A. the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244). B. the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277). C. organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266). D. they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Laissez-faire individualism** with **the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which position confines government mainly to protection, justice, contract and external defence?

A. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas B. Laissez-faire individualism C. Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom D. Class theory of the state

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244)** with **Laissez-faire individualism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Welfare / positive liberal state**?

A. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279). B. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270). C. the state should create conditions for moral freedom and social welfare, especially for vulnerable sections (PDF pp.245-260). D. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Welfare / positive liberal state** with **the state should create conditions for moral freedom and social welfare, especially for vulnerable sections (PDF pp.245-260)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which position argues that public action may be needed to create the real conditions of freedom and self-development?

A. Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed B. Organic theory C. Communitarian perspective D. Welfare / positive liberal state

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state should create conditions for moral freedom and social welfare, especially for vulnerable sections (PDF pp.245-260)** with **Welfare / positive liberal state**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Class theory of the state**?

A. the state arises with private property and class division and serves dominant-class power (PDF pp.261-266). B. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270). C. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236). D. they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Class theory of the state** with **the state arises with private property and class division and serves dominant-class power (PDF pp.261-266)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which theory explains the state through private property, class division and dominant-class power?

A. MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor B. Class theory of the state C. Social-contract theory D. Post-colonial perspective

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state arises with private property and class division and serves dominant-class power (PDF pp.261-266)** with **Class theory of the state**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Communitarian perspective**?

A. organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279). B. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236). C. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270). D. the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Communitarian perspective** with **the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which perspective rejects the detached liberal self and starts from socially embedded identity and shared goods?

A. Gandhi B. Laissez-faire individualism C. Gandhian perspective D. Communitarian perspective

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270)** with **Communitarian perspective**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Post-colonial perspective**?

A. the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273). B. laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277). C. they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244). D. he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Post-colonial perspective** with **the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which perspective studies inherited borders, elites, institutions and dependencies after formal empire?

A. Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged B. Post-colonial perspective C. Welfare / positive liberal state D. Feminist perspective

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273)** with **Post-colonial perspective**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Gandhian perspective**?

A. organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266). B. they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260). C. the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277). D. both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhian perspective** with **the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which perspective treats centralised authority as coercive and places swaraj and moral self-rule above state machinery?

A. Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom B. Class theory of the state C. Pluralist perspective D. Gandhian perspective

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277)** with **Gandhian perspective**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Feminist perspective**?

A. the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and institutions (PDF pp.277-278). B. the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222). C. they see the state through class domination, though neo-Marxists debate how far the state is relatively autonomous (PDF pp.261-267). Gramsci was the first neo-Marxist to concede relative autonomy of the state, distinguishing political society (which relies on force/direct domination through "juridical" government) from civil society (which relies on consent/"hegemony" through family, school and church) (PDF p.266). D. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminist perspective** with **the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and institutions (PDF pp.277-278)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which perspective makes family, sexuality, labour and welfare part of the analysis of political power?

A. Organic theory B. Feminist perspective C. Communitarian perspective D. Ethical institution vs instrument

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and institutions (PDF pp.277-278)** with **Feminist perspective**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Pluralist perspective**?

A. Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222). B. Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy. C. the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF pp.278-279). D. the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Pluralist perspective** with **the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF pp.278-279)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which perspective treats the state as coordinator among several associations rather than the sole centre of power?

A. Social-contract theory B. Post-colonial perspective C. Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule D. Pluralist perspective

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF pp.278-279)** with **Pluralist perspective**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Ethical institution vs instrument**?

A. organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279). B. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236). C. they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270). D. the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ethical institution vs instrument** with **organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally** (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which distinction separates an exalted moral whole from a device used for security, welfare, class rule or coordination?

A. Laissez-faire individualism B. Ethical institution vs instrument C. Gandhian perspective D. State above society vs state within society

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally** (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279). with **Ethical institution vs instrument**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule**?

A. they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244). B. organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266). C. laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277). D. both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule** with **laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination** (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277). The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which distinction compares non-interference, enabling capacity and disciplined swaraj?

A. Welfare / positive liberal state B. Feminist perspective C. Aristotle D. Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination** (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277). with **Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule**. The other

options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **State above society vs state within society**?

A. organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266). B. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279). C. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270). D. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **State above society vs state within society** with **organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which distinction tests whether political authority absorbs society or remains one institution among social forces?

A. Class theory of the state B. State above society vs state within society C. Pluralist perspective D. Burke and Hegel

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266)** with **State above society vs state within society**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Aristotle**?

A. they see the state through class domination, though neo-Marxists debate how far the state is relatively autonomous (PDF pp.261-267). Gramsci was the first neo-Marxist to concede relative autonomy of the state, distinguishing political society (which relies on force/direct domination through "juridical" government) from civil society (which relies on consent/"hegemony" through family, school and church) (PDF p.266). B. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279). C. the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222). D. the state arises with private property and class division and serves dominant-class power (PDF pp.261-266).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Aristotle** with **the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Who argues that the state exists for life and continues for the good life?

A. Communitarian perspective B. Ethical institution vs instrument C. Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau D. Aristotle

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222)** with **Aristotle**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Burke and Hegel**?

- A. Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222).
B. Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy. C. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270). D. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Burke and Hegel** with **Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which pairing combines historical-organic growth with the modern idealist elevation of the ethical state?

- A. Post-colonial perspective B. Burke and Hegel C. Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule D. Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222)** with **Burke and Hegel**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau**?

- A. they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270). B. the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273). C. all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236). D. laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau** with **all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which group uses contract to defend security, limited rights-protection and popular sovereignty in different ways?

- A. Gandhian perspective B. State above society vs state within society C. J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver D. Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236)** with **Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick**?

A. they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244). B. he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277). C. the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277). D. organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick** with **they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which group supplies distinct market, utilitarian, evolutionary and rights-based arguments for limited government?

A. Feminist perspective B. Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick C. Aristotle D. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244)** with **Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver**?

A. both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points. B. the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and institutions (PDF pp.277-278). C. they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260). D. the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver** with **they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which group revises liberalism toward social responsibility, positive liberty, welfare and service?

A. Pluralist perspective B. Burke and Hegel C. Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed D. J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260)** with **J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas**?

A. they see the state through class domination, though neo-Marxists debate how far the state is relatively autonomous (PDF pp.261-267). Gramsci was the first neo-Marxist to concede relative autonomy of the state, distinguishing political society (which relies on force/direct domination through "juridical" government) from civil society (which relies on consent/"hegemony" through family, school and church) (PDF p.266). B. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279). C. the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF pp.278-279). D. Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas** with **they see the state through class domination, though neo-Marxists debate how far the state is relatively autonomous (PDF pp.261-267). Gramsci was the first neo-Marxist to concede relative autonomy of the state, distinguishing political society (which relies on force/direct domination through "juridical" government) from civil society (which relies on consent/"hegemony" through family, school and church) (PDF p.266)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which group develops class accounts from coercive rule through hegemony, instrumentalism and relative autonomy?

A. Ethical institution vs instrument B. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas C. Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau D. MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **they see the state through class domination, though neo-Marxists debate how far the state is relatively autonomous (PDF pp.261-267). Gramsci was the first neo-Marxist to concede relative autonomy of the state, distinguishing political society (which relies on force/direct domination through "juridical" government) from civil society (which relies on consent/"hegemony" through family, school and church) (PDF p.266)** with **Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed**?

A. the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223). B. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270). C. Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy. D. organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed** with **Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which debate contrasts direct elite capture and leverage with structural service under relative autonomy?

A. Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule B. Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick C. Gandhi D. Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy.** with **Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor**?

A. they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270). B. the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236). C. the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273). D. laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor** with **they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which group criticises the unencumbered self through tradition, community, differentiated spheres and recognition?

A. State above society vs state within society B. MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor C. J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver D. Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).** with **MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Gandhi**?

A. the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244). B. organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266). C. he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277). D. they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhi** with **he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Who links criticism of the coercive state to ahimsa, trusteeship, bread labour and decentralised swaraj?

A. Aristotle B. Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas C. Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom D. Gandhi

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277).** with **Gandhi.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged**?

A. both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points. B. the state should create conditions for moral freedom and social welfare, especially for vulnerable sections (PDF pp.245-260). C. the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222). D. they see the state through class domination, though neo-Marxists debate how far the state is relatively autonomous (PDF pp.261-267). Gramsci was the first neo-Marxist to concede relative autonomy of the state, distinguishing political society (which relies on force/direct domination through "juridical" government) from civil society (which relies on consent/"hegemony" through family, school and church) (PDF p.266).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged** with **both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which pairing must be separated into intimate power and personal politics on one side, and liberal-state neutrality plus political economy on the other?

A. Burke and Hegel B. Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged C. Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed D. Organic theory

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points** with **Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom**?

A. the state arises with private property and class division and serves dominant-class power (PDF pp.261-266). B. Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222). C. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279). D. Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom** with **they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which group develops associational and polyarchic accounts of dispersed power, while recognising unequal groups?

A. Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau B. MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor C. Social-contract theory D. Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279)** with **Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Compare the organic and social-contract perspectives on the origin and purpose of the state. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Organic and social-contract theories differ fundamentally over whether the state is a natural ethical whole or an artificial institution created by individuals.

Core analysis: Aristotle treats political association as the completion of human sociability and the condition of the good life; Burke stresses historical growth, while Hegel elevates the state's ethical significance. Contract thinkers begin from individuals outside political authority. Hobbes creates an absolute sovereign for security, Locke a limited trust for rights, and Rousseau a popular sovereign that converts natural into civil freedom. Contract thus makes legitimacy depend on an account of authorisation and purpose rather than organic priority.

Critical evaluation: Organic theory captures interdependence but can subordinate conscience and blur state with society. Contract theory disciplines authority through consent, yet its historical fiction and abstract equality can conceal inherited power. Neither origin story alone settles legitimate state action.

Conclusion: Organic theory explains embedded political membership but risks absorption, while contract theory makes authority answerable to consent but relies on simplified origin stories and unequal imagined contractors.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish the laissez-faire state from the welfare or positive-liberal state. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Laissez-faire and welfare liberalism share individual freedom as an end but disagree about whether non-interference is sufficient to make freedom real.

Core analysis: The laissez-faire state protects life, property, contract, justice and defence while treating wider intervention as a threat to liberty and spontaneous market order. Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer and Nozick supply different rationales for limited government. Welfare or positive liberalism emerges from the harms of industrial capitalism. J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski and MacIver argue that education, health, labour protection and social security can remove obstacles to self-development. Rights arise within social interdependence, so the state serves freedom by enabling capacity.

Critical evaluation: Welfare action can become paternalistic or stabilise unequal property relations, while minimal government leaves private domination untouched. The defensible distinction is negative protection versus publicly secured enabling conditions, not liberty versus coercion in the abstract.

Conclusion: The welfare state corrects minimal liberalism by treating enabling conditions as part of freedom, though it remains contested whether regulation reforms or stabilises deeper structures of inequality.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine the Marxist theory of the state with reference to Miliband and Poulantzas. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Marxist theory interprets the state through class power, while neo-Marxism disputes direct capture versus structural service.

Core analysis: Classical Marxism links the state to private property, class division and coercive protection of dominant interests. Miliband's instrumentalism identifies shared elite backgrounds, capital's direct economic leverage and officials' stake in the existing system. Poulantzas replies that the capitalist state requires relative autonomy: it must organise competing fractions, claim to represent the people and secure long-term system stability rather than obey individual capitalists mechanically. The state is therefore an arena of class struggle as well as an institution functionally related to capitalism.

Further development: Gramsci bridges the positions by distinguishing coercive political society from consent-producing civil society. Relative autonomy can therefore organise hegemony and long-term capitalist stability rather than negate class power. Because hegemony must be renewed, counter-hegemonic struggle remains possible without treating every decision as a direct capitalist command.

Critical evaluation: Relative autonomy prevents crude personnel sociology, but if expanded without limit it dissolves the Marxist claim being explained. The strongest position treats autonomy as real, institutionally variable and bounded by structural dependence on accumulation and social order.

Conclusion: Neo-Marxist debate replaces a crude instrument model with bounded relative autonomy: the state may mediate among interests while remaining structurally tied to the reproduction of capitalist power.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Gandhian and pluralist criticisms of centralised state power. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Gandhian and pluralist theories both challenge the monopolistic state, but they rest on different moral anthropologies and institutional remedies.

Core analysis: Gandhi treats the centralised state as a soulless coercive machine and locates freedom in swaraj, self-discipline, non-violence, trusteeship and village-centred moral reconstruction. Pluralists such as Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom emphasise multiple associations and centres of power. They seek freedom of association, dispersed bargaining and a state that coordinates or arbitrates rather than absorbs society. Gandhi points beyond dependence on state machinery; pluralism redesigns authority within modern institutional democracy.

Further development: Their accounts of obedience also differ. Gandhi forms an ethical subject capable of resisting unjust authority through disciplined non-violence; pluralism organises enduring interests through representation and checks. A defensible synthesis protects decentralised association while retaining safeguards against local oppression, unequal resources and violent conflict.

Critical evaluation: Gandhian decentralisation may be difficult to scale and can romanticise community, while pluralism can overlook unequal resources and domination within groups. Both require rights and coordination if dispersal is to produce freedom rather than local hierarchy or stalemate.

Conclusion: Both disperse authority, but Gandhi grounds decentralisation in moral self-rule and non-violence, whereas pluralism institutionalises competing associations under a residual coordinating public order.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate diverse perspectives on the state through origin, purpose, liberty, inequality, civil society and route to change. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Diverse state theories become analytically comparable only when each is tested through the same dimensions rather than narrated as an unrelated list.

Core analysis: Organic theory makes the state natural and ethical; contract theory makes it artificial and authorised; laissez-faire protects negative liberty, while welfare liberalism secures enabling conditions. Their purposes diverge across good life, security and rights, market order, welfare, class rule, post-colonial state-building, swaraj and pluralist coordination. On inequality, organic theory may naturalise hierarchy, laissez-faire accepts market outcomes, and welfare, Marxist, post-colonial and feminist views expose social structures that produce unequal power. On civil society, organic theory tends to absorb it, liberals protect it, Gramsci treats it as a site of hegemony, Gandhi privileges moral community and pluralists make associations a democratic restraint. Routes to change range from cultivation and constitutional reform to revolution, decolonisation, non-violence and associational redistribution.

Further development: The 1-2 July 2026 National Conference on e-Governance provides a limited current illustration of competing state images. Its emphasis on AI-enabled, data-driven and secure digital governance presents the state as a service and capacity-building institution rather than only a sovereign commander. Yet the same technologies raise questions of surveillance, unequal access, administrative neutrality and accountability that liberal, welfare, Marxist, feminist and pluralist perspectives judge differently. A current programme is therefore evidence for applying the six-test grid, not proof that one theory has won.

Critical evaluation: Each lens illuminates one dimension but becomes misleading when universalised. A reasoned verdict should identify the actual problem in the question-order, freedom, class, coloniality, gender or coordination-and combine insights without erasing doctrinal disagreement.

Conclusion: No single image exhausts the state; disciplined comparison reveals which dimension each theory illuminates and where its universalisation obscures coercion, dependence or legitimate common action.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: How do feminist and post-colonial perspectives widen classical state theory? Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Feminist and post-colonial perspectives widen state theory by challenging the supposedly universal subject and history presupposed by classical accounts.

Core analysis: Post-colonial analysis shows that newly independent states inherit borders, bureaucracies, elites and economic dependencies formed under empire. Formal sovereignty must therefore be joined to nation-building, state-building and decolonisation of institutions and values. Feminist theory shows that the public state is constituted through power in family, sexuality, labour and welfare. Kate Millett expands politics into intimate domination, while Zillah Eisenstein attacks the liberal state's claimed neutrality and its dependence on gendered paid and unpaid labour.

Further development: The perspectives intersect without becoming identical. Colonial rule often reorganised family law, labour, land and bureaucracy through gendered categories, while post-colonial development can rely on women's unpaid care and inherited administrative hierarchies. Feminist analysis prevents national liberation from being treated as sufficient emancipation; post-colonial analysis prevents gender theory from assuming a universal Western institutional history. Their combined lesson is intersectional and historical: state power is located in public institutions, intimate relations and transnational structures at once.

Critical evaluation: Neither perspective simply adds another disadvantaged group. Each changes the concept of power and legitimacy: the state must answer for the histories and private structures through which citizens become unequal. Their internal diversity also prevents one post-colonial or feminist state model from becoming final.

Conclusion: Feminist and post-colonial theories expose the hidden histories and social locations of supposedly universal state categories, extending legitimacy from formal public authority to gendered, colonial and institutional

power.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.